said in an interview, "I think he broke the law, so I certainly wouldn't characterize him as a hero. You won't find much admiration from me." Marc Andreessen, founder of Netscape, told CNBC, "If you looked up in the encyclopedia 'traitor,' there's a picture of Edward Snowden."[8]

Or a Hero?

Though the tide of opinion flowed mostly against Snowden, he also had supporters. Daniel Ellsberg, leaker of the Pentagon Papers and one of the most famous whistle-blowers in history, posted on his Twitter page, "Edward Snowden has done more for our Constitution in terms of the Fourth and First Amendment than anyone else I know."[9] The Fourth Amendment prohibits unreasonable searches and seizures without a warrant,

PUBLIC OPINION ABOUT THE LEAKS

Although most polls suggested that a majority of Americans believed Snowden acted illegally by leaking national security documents and that he should be prosecuted, a majority also believed the public had a right to know about the programs he revealed. In July 2013, a public opinion poll conducted by Pew Research found that, for the first time since 2004, many Americans, 47 percent to 35 percent, believed US government antiterror policies had gone too far in restricting civil liberties. In the same poll, 56 percent of Americans believed federal courts were failing to limit communications gathered by the government.[10]

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